

more accessible than ever before.

As the concept of the metaverse continues to take root, the divide between the physical and the virtual will become increasingly blurred. The growing popularity of the metaverse will fundamentally transform the way we interact with our physical and virtual environments. This impact is felt most acutely in the form of value transfer and ownership – how does one reconcile the transactions that are taking place in the digi-physical world? As the lines between physical and virtual realms continue to blur, a novel class of asset and store of value is needed to bridge between these two worlds – this is where crypto enters the picture. Crypto is undoubtedly the future of financial access in the metaverse.

While JPMorgan lay claims of being the first bank in the metaverse, this step is arguably first pioneered by the crypto sector since 2009. Beyond banking, there is a more urgent need for a virtual medium of exchange within the virtual realm that is fast, secure, and transparent.

Operated on a public digital ledger and driven by blockchain technology, crypto assets ensure that every transaction in the metaverse is traceable and secured using highly sophisticated cryptography techniques without sacrificing speed or incurring high transaction costs. Crypto assets are also extremely interoperable due to several crypto exchanges facilitating transfers across blockchains and can be scaled quickly to cater to rising transaction volumes.

Moreover, the power to validate transactions rests with every participant in the blockchain network on which the crypto asset is built, making it democratic and more tenable to achieving an equitable digital ecosystem. This is paramount as consumers are empowered within the decision-making

process and are involved in the maintenance of the financial ecosystem and are spared from the shortfalls of traditional institutions.

As people embark on their journey towards the open and decentralised metaverse, crypto exchanges will play a key role in onboarding users by facilitating the purchase and sales of metaverse tokens. These tokens are fundamental to interactions in the metaverse – users can live their digital lives and transact with these tokens much like how they use cash in the real world. Besides the buying and selling of metaverse tokens, crypto exchanges also provides liquidity to the metaverse, facilitating increasing volumes of transactions that will shape of the economics of the metaverse.

The growth of the crypto sector, and the critical role it plays at the heart of the metaverse means that crypto exchanges will now be at the forefront of the world's financial transformation. Crypto exchanges form the bedrock of the financial ecosystem and economy of the metaverse. They play a critical role in providing investors and consumers with the wherewithal to manage their wealth in a decentralised and digital future.

Furthermore, as digital assets continue to develop and grow, crypto exchanges will play a powerful role in intermediating duality of the metaverse, playing an outsized role in shaping the digi-physical realm. Users can easily purchase NFT through crypto exchanges in the metaverse, engaging seamlessly from any part of the world in a borderless digital realm. Although it is still a nascent space, the metaverse is set to displace the traditional methods of consumption on the internet and crypto exchanges will be the epicentre of the digital economy in the near future.

Just as the industrial revolution ushered in an era of large-scale industrialisation, the metaverse will break down barriers and bring the world closer together — be it on a social, financial or entertainment level. Blockchain infrastructure is the key to tapping into the wider crypto economy, making virtual assets interchangeable for real economic value beyond the confines of the metaverse. As the digital economy rapidly progresses, channelling immense amounts of financial capital to the virtual realm, crypto exchanges will be the engine that will power the future of virtual and physical worlds alike.

